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although based on different segment definitions, indicate the scale of the opportunity.

"India has been one of the most dynamic markets in the region over the last few years," says Guillaume Boilot, Managing Director of TAG Heuer for the Middle East, India, Africa, and Turkey. While India is not yet among the brand's largest markets in absolute terms, Boilot expects it to become a key pillar of the region over the next five years.

Neeraj Walia, MD & CEO at Montblanc India Retail Private Ltd, echoes the optimism. Its watch business is also expanding strongly, supported by new launches, collector engagement, and investments in boutique experiences.

The Montblanc Star Legacy Nicolas Rieussec Chronograph, priced at approximately ₹8.5 lakh, is one of the most popular watches in India.

A NEW GENERATION

"Customers are no longer looking only at the name on the dial; they are asking about movements, complications, production quantities, craftsmanship, rarity, and the story," says Erol Baliyan, CEO of Franck Muller for the Middle East, Africa, and India. The brand is available at 16 retail locations across 10 Indian cities, including two Franck Muller boutiques.

In mid-October, Franck Muller launched the Vanguard "Ram Lalla" Limited Edition, created specifically for India and limited to 108 pieces. Priced at ₹31,25,000, the watch is a tribute to Lord Ram in his childhood form. Previously, in 2022, the Swiss luxury watch manufacturer had introduced India specific watches such as the Vanguard India Limited Edition (priced between ₹11.70 lakh and ₹18.72 lakh) to mark India's 75th year of Independence.

The edition comprised 150 pieces with each individually numbered piece featuring a map of India engraved on the caseback. It also launched the Vanguard Slim "Men in Blue" Special Edition (₹13.41 lakh), limited to 47 pieces, featuring a sky-blue dial with distinctive 3D-embossed Devanagari numerals, in 2023.

Boilot says TAG Heuer's Indian customers are becoming noticeably younger, frequently in their late twenties and thirties.

They arrive at stores already familiar with the collections, technical specifications, and racing heritage. Its Carrera remains a particularly strong performer, while the Formula 1 collection appeals to younger buyers. The Monaco attracts enthusiasts seeking distinctive designs.

"India has the potential to become one of our most important markets over the next five years. The growth we are seeing is significant, but what excites me most is what is driving that growth. There is a new generation of collectors with strong knowledge, confidence in their taste, and an appetite for complicated and distinctive watchmaking," says Benjamin Arabov, CEO of Jacob & Co. The brand has three boutiques in India—in Mumbai and Delhi.

Yashovardhan Saboo, Founder and Chairman of Ethos Watches, identifies several distinct consumer groups: wealthy families, serious enthusiasts, wedding- and occasion-led buyers, and first-time professionals graduating from smartwatches to

1 TAG Heuer's Carrera, a strong performer in India

2 The Montblanc Star Legacy Nicolas Rieussec Chronograph

3 Franck Muller's Galet collection